

LEC # 06

PRINCIPLE OF MANAGEMENT

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Leadership and the Influence Process

Leadership is the ability to influence, guide, and inspire individuals or groups to achieve organizational goals. A leader does not only give instructions but also motivates and supports their team to perform at their best. Leadership is crucial in shaping the vision of the organization, building strong teams, and managing change effectively.

Approaches to Leadership

1. Trait Theory

Trait Theory is one of the earliest leadership theories. It suggests that leaders are born with certain **inherent characteristics** or traits that make them effective. These traits often include intelligence, confidence, integrity, determination, and charisma. The theory assumes that if someone possesses these traits, they are more likely to be a successful leader. However, this theory has been criticized for

not considering the influence of environment or behavior, and for not explaining why people with similar traits may perform differently.

2. Behavioral Theory

Unlike Trait Theory, Behavioral Theory focuses on **what leaders do**, not who they are. It studies the behaviors and actions of effective leaders. Typically, it categorizes leadership styles into two types: **task-oriented** (concerned with getting the job done) and **people-oriented** (focused on team well-being and motivation). The idea is that leadership can be learned through training and experience, rather than being an inborn quality. It emphasizes that leadership is about behavior and decision-making.

3. Contingency Theory

Contingency Theory states that there is **no single best style of leadership**. Instead, the effectiveness of a leadership style depends on the **situation or context**. For example, a task-oriented style might work well in a crisis, while a relationship-oriented style might be better for building long-term team morale. One well-known model is **Fiedler's**

Contingency Theory, which matches leaders to situations based on their natural style and the task at hand.

4. Transformational Leadership

Transformational Leadership focuses on leaders who **inspire and motivate** followers to exceed expectations. These leaders are visionary, charismatic, and supportive. They create a strong sense of purpose, encourage innovation, and build personal connections with their team. Transformational leaders help employees grow, believe in the organizational mission, and feel emotionally invested in their work. This type of leadership is highly effective in dynamic and change-driven environments.

Power and Politics in Organizations

In every organization, **power** and **politics** play a significant role in shaping behavior, decisions, and outcomes. **Power** is the ability to influence the behavior of others or control resources. It is not limited to those in high-ranking positions; even employees at lower levels can hold power, depending on their skills, information, or relationships. The most common

types of organizational power include **legitimate power** (based on position or authority), **expert power** (based on knowledge or skills), **referent power** (based on charisma or likability), **coercive power** (based on fear or punishment), and **reward power** (based on the ability to give benefits or rewards).

1.Legitimate Power (Based on Position or Authority)

Legitimate power is the formal authority granted to an individual based on their position within the organizational hierarchy. This type of power comes from the role a person holds, not necessarily from their personality, knowledge, or influence. For example, a team leader, manager, or director has the legitimate power to assign tasks, make decisions, approve leaves, or enforce company policies. Employees accept this power because it is recognized and supported by the organization's structure and rules. Legitimate power is essential for maintaining order and ensuring that the

organization runs efficiently. However, it must be used responsibly—if a manager misuses this power or becomes too authoritarian, it can lead to resistance, low morale, or a toxic environment.

2.Expert Power (Based on Knowledge or Skills)

Expert power arises from a person's **specialized knowledge, skills, or expertise** in a particular field that others value or depend on. Unlike legitimate power, which is tied to a formal position, expert power is based on what a person knows and how effectively they can apply that knowledge to solve problems or improve outcomes. For example, an IT specialist who knows how to secure a company's network, or a software engineer with deep experience in a specific programming language, holds expert power because others rely on their technical abilities and judgment. This type of power often leads to respect and influence, even if the person does not hold a high-ranking title. Expert power is especially important in knowledge-based industries like technology, healthcare, and education, where decision-making often depends on professional insights.

3.Referent Power (Based on Charisma or Likability)

This type of power doesn't come from a formal title or expertise but rather from the emotional connection and trust others feel toward the individual. People with referent power are often seen as role models—colleagues want to follow them, not because they have to, but because they genuinely respect and like them. For example, a team member who consistently supports others, communicates well, and maintains a positive attitude might naturally become influential in group decisions, even without a managerial title. Leaders with referent power can build strong, motivated teams because they lead by example and create a sense of belonging. However, this power depends heavily on personal integrity and consistency—once trust is broken, referent power can quickly fade.

4.Coercive Power (Based on Fear or Punishment)

Coercive power is the ability to influence others through the **threat of punishment or negative consequences**. This type of power is rooted in fear—employees comply with directives to avoid unpleasant outcomes such as demotion, disciplinary action, job loss, or public criticism. For example, a manager who threatens to cut bonuses if deadlines aren't met, or who

publicly criticizes poor performance, is exercising coercive power. While this power can be effective in urgent situations or in enforcing rules, it often creates a tense and negative work environment if overused. Employees under coercive leadership may follow orders, but they are likely to feel stressed, demotivated, and disengaged.

5.Reward Power (Based on Giving Rewards)

Reward power means the ability to influence people by giving them rewards. These rewards can be things like money, promotions, praise, extra holidays, or any other benefit. When a manager has reward power, employees listen to them because they know they can get something good in return if they do a good job.

Example: If a team leader says, “Anyone who finishes their work early will get a bonus,” that leader is using reward power. People follow because they want the reward.

This type of power is usually positive and motivates people to work better. But it should be used fairly. If only a few people get rewards even when others work hard, it can create problems or make others feel left out.

Organizational politics refers to activities undertaken to gain, develop, and use power to influence others and achieve personal or organizational goals, often in unofficial or informal ways. Politics becomes visible when individuals use networking, alliances, persuasion, or even manipulation to push their agendas or protect their interests.

1. Networking

Networking means building and maintaining relationships with people who can help you in your career. It involves talking to colleagues, managers, or people from other departments, attending meetings, or joining professional groups. Through networking, employees get access to new opportunities, support, and information that may not be available to everyone.

Example: An employee builds strong connections with senior managers, which helps them get promoted faster.

2. Coalitions

Coalitions are groups of people who come together to support a common goal or protect their shared interests. These groups can influence decisions by showing strength in numbers. People form coalitions when they feel that working together will give them more power or a better chance to achieve something.

Example: A group of employees teams up to convince management to allow remote work options.

3. Impression Management

Impression management is when people try to control how others see them. They do this by dressing professionally, speaking politely, sharing their achievements, or acting in ways that make them look confident and capable. The goal is to create a positive image and gain trust or approval from others — especially from managers or important people in the organization.

Example: An employee always highlights their success in meetings to show they are a top performer.